Codebook — pew2025.csv

Pew American Trends Panel, Wave 165 (March 2025) — team project extract

About this dataset

The American Trends Panel is Pew Research Center's nationally representative online survey panel of adults in the United States. Wave 165 was fielded from March 10 to 16, 2025, and asked about news habits, trust in news sources and trust in other people. Its published reports include "News Media Tracker: How Americans Use and Trust News Sources" and "Americans' Trust in One Another."

Every respondent was asked every question in this extract, so unlike the GSS file there are no ballots to worry about. Each row is one respondent. There are 1,868 rows and 73 columns.

Wave 165 interviewed 9,482 panelists. This extract is a random sample of 1,868 of them, drawn so that all three team-project datasets are the same size and the choice of dataset is purely one of subject matter.

This sample is large. With 1,868 respondents, even a difference too small to matter can come out statistically significant. Men and women differ in news attention by less than a tenth of a point on the four-point scale, yet the difference is significant ($p = .008$) with an effect size of only $d = 0.13$. Report an effect size alongside every test and say plainly whether the difference is large enough to be worth talking about. A significant result is not automatically an interesting one.

Missing values

Two codes mark answers that are not usable, following the same convention as the datasets used in class:

- 999 = Don't know, refused, or left blank. Pew records these three as a single code, so 998 does not appear in this file.
- −1 = Not applicable (the question did not apply to this respondent)

These codes are real numbers in the file, so they will be included in a mean or a frequency table unless you remove them. Recode them as missing before any analysis. The starter notebook shows you how.

The −1 code appears in two places. Respondents who do not use the internet were never asked how often they hit a paywall. And in the eight use_ and trust_ columns, −1 means the respondent had never heard of that outlet, so was never shown it, which is itself worth thinking about before you drop those rows.

The five derived variables

Five variables at the end of the file were built for you, because the required tests need outcomes that can be treated as continuous. Three are index scores, each the average of four survey items, reversed so that a higher score always means more of the thing named. The other two simply count outlets. Every item that goes into an index is also in the file on its own, so you may build your own index instead, or analyze the items separately.

A note on the "n" column

The n column gives the number of respondents with a usable answer, that is, after 999 and −1 have been removed. When you cross two variables, your working sample is the number of people with a usable answer on both. Always report the n your test actually used.

Variables

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
caseid	Case identifier	id	1868	7–9481
folnews	How closely follows the news	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1863	1=All or most of the time; 2=Some of the time; 3=Only now and then; 4=Hardly ever
seeknews	How often intentionally seeks out news	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1867	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winpol	Importance that news sources share your political views	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1859	1=Extremely important; 2=Very important; 3=Somewhat important; 4=Not too important; 5=Not at all important
news_pay	Paid for news in the past 12 months	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1865	1=Yes; 2=No
paywall1	How often hits a news paywall	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1830	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
fundnprpbs	Views on federal funding for NPR and PBS	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=Congress should remove federal government funding from NPR and PBS; 2=NPR and PBS should continue to receive funding from the federal government; 3=Not sure
soctrust4	How much most people can be trusted	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1865	1=A great deal; 2=A fair amount; 3=Not too much; 4=Not at all
chgtrst	Change in trust in others in recent years	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1858	1=Increased a lot; 2=Increased a little; 3=Stayed about the same; 4=Decreased a little; 5=Decreased a lot
trust_nhbr	Trust in neighbors	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1858	1=All of the people in your neighborhood; 2=Most of the people in your neighborhood; 3=Some of the people in your neighborhood; 4=None

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
				of the people in your neighborhood
neighknow	How well knows neighbors	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1862	1=Know all of them; 2=Know most of them; 3=Know only some of them; 4=Don't know any of them
safe	How safe feels in the neighborhood at night	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1866	1=Extremely safe; 2=Very safe; 3=Somewhat safe; 4=Not too safe; 5=Not at all safe
satis	Satisfaction with the way things are going	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1864	1=Satisfied; 2=Dissatisfied
news_level_a	Follows international news	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1867	1=Very closely; 2=Somewhat closely; 3=Not very closely; 4=Not at all closely
news_level_b	Follows national news	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1866	1=Very closely; 2=Somewhat closely; 3=Not very closely; 4=Not at all closely
news_level_c	Follows local news	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1867	1=Very closely; 2=Somewhat closely; 3=Not very closely; 4=Not at all closely
news_level_d	Follows neighborhood news	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1865	1=Very closely; 2=Somewhat closely; 3=Not very closely; 4=Not at all closely
topicnews_a	Gets news about government and politics	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1864	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
topicnews_b	Gets news about sports	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1868	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
topicnews_c	Gets news about business and finance	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1866	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
topicnews_d	Gets news about science and technology	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1865	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
topicnews_e	Gets news about entertainment	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1864	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
group_trust_a	Trusts information from national news organizations	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1866	1=A lot; 2=Some; 3=Not too much; 4=Not at all
group_trust_b	Trusts information from local news organizations	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1860	1=A lot; 2=Some; 3=Not too much; 4=Not at all
group_trust_c	Trusts information from friends, family and acquaintances	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=A lot; 2=Some; 3=Not too much; 4=Not at all
group_trust_d	Trusts information from social media sites	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1865	1=A lot; 2=Some; 3=Not too much; 4=Not at all

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
winfeeling_a	News makes me feel scared	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1864	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_b	News makes me feel confused	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1861	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_c	News makes me feel sad	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1863	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_d	News makes me feel angry	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1862	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_e	News makes me feel happy	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1862	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_f	News makes me feel hopeful	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1864	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_g	News makes me feel informed	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1865	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
winfeeling_h	News makes me feel empowered	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1856	1=Extremely often; 2=Often; 3=Sometimes; 4=Rarely; 5=Never
gender	Gender	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1862	1=A man; 2=A woman; 3=In some other way
agecat	Age category	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1861	1=18-29; 2=30-49; 3=50-64; 4=65+
educcat	Education level	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=College graduate+; 2=Some College; 3=H.S. graduate or less
racethnmod	Race and ethnicity	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1844	1=White non-Hispanic; 2=Black non-Hispanic; 3=Hispanic; 4=Other; 5=Asian non-Hispanic
marital	Marital status	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1859	1=Married; 2=Living with a partner; 3=Divorced; 4=Separated; 5=Widowed; 6=Never been married
religcat1	Religion (condensed)	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1857	1=Protestant; 2=Catholic; 3=Unaffiliated; 4=Other
attendper	Attendance at religious services	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1861	1=More than once a week; 2=Once a week; 3=Once or twice a month; 4=A few times a year; 5=Seldom; 6=Never
party_final	Party identification	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1858	1=Republican; 2=Democrat; 3=Independent; 4=Something else
partysum_final	Party summary (including leaners)	binary (t test grouping / chi-	1820	1=Rep/Lean Rep; 2=Dem/Lean Dem

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
		square)		
ideo	Political ideology	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1846	1=Very conservative; 2=Conservative; 3=Moderate; 4=Liberal; 5=Very liberal
inc_sdt1	Family income	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1782	1=Less than $30,000; 2=$30,000 to less than $40,000; 3=$40,000 to less than $50,000; 4=$50,000 to less than $60,000; 5=$60,000 to less than $70,000; 6=$70,000 to less than $80,000; 7=$80,000 to less than $90,000; 8=$90,000 to less than $100,000; 9=$100,000 or more
inc_tier2	Income tier	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1756	1=Lower income; 2=Middle income; 3=Upper income
intfreq	Frequency of internet use	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1860	1=Almost constantly; 2=Several times a day; 3=About once a day; 4=Several times a week; 5=Less often; 6=Do not use the internet
cregion	Census region	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1865	1=Northeast; 2=Midwest; 3=South; 4=West
usr_selfid	Self-identified community type	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1851	1=Urban; 2=Suburban; 3=Rural
metro	Metropolitan area	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1865	1=Metropolitan; 2=Non-metropolitan
reg	Voter registration	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1868	1=You are ABSOLUTELY CERTAIN that you are registered to vote at your current address; 2=You are PROBABLY registered, but there is a chance your registration has lapsed; 3=You are NOT registered to vote at your current address/Refused/Missing
volsum	Volunteering status	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1857	1=Yes; 2=No
use_fox	Regularly gets news from Fox News	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1774	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_fox	Generally trusts Fox News as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1774	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_cnn	Regularly gets news from CNN	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1804	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_cnn	Generally trusts CNN as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1804	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_nyt	Regularly gets news	binary (chi-	1647	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
	from The New York Times	square / t test grouping)		not heard of this source)
trust_nyt	Generally trusts The New York Times as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1647	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_npr	Regularly gets news from NPR	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1276	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_npr	Generally trusts NPR as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1276	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_abc	Regularly gets news from ABC News	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1777	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_abc	Generally trusts ABC News as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1777	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_msn	Regularly gets news from MSNBC	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1679	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_msn	Generally trusts MSNBC as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1679	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_joe	Regularly gets news from The Joe Rogan Experience	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1176	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_joe	Generally trusts The Joe Rogan Experience as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	1176	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
use_max	Regularly gets news from Newsmax	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	897	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
trust_max	Generally trusts Newsmax as a news source	binary (chi-square / t test grouping)	897	0=not selected; 1=selected (−1 = has not heard of this source)
newsattention	News attention index — mean of the four "how closely do you follow" items, reversed so that a higher score means closer attention (Cronbach's α = .71)	continuous	1868	1.00–4.00 (mean of four items)
negemotion	Negative news emotion index — mean of scared, confused, sad and angry, reversed so that a higher score means more often (α = .79)	continuous	1867	1.00–5.00 (mean of four items)
posemotion	Positive news emotion index — mean of	continuous	1866	1.00–5.00 (mean of four items)

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
	happy, hopeful, informed and empowered, reversed so that a higher score means more often (α = .75)			
n_used	Number of the eight listed outlets the respondent regularly gets news from	continuous	1868	0–8
n_trusted	Number of the eight listed outlets the respondent generally trusts	continuous	1868	0–8

Source: Pew Research Center, American Trends Panel Wave 165, fielded March 10–16, 2025 (N = 9,482, of whom a random sample of 1,868 is used here). The full questionnaire, codebook and methodology are in the download package from pewresearch.org. The survey weight has been omitted from this extract, and all analyses in this course are unweighted.